

topsolinux: TopSolid on Linux

Short guide to installing and using TopSolid 7 with its local PDM under Linux

topsolinux is a patched Wine plus an installer that sets up TopSolid from **your own** TopSolid installation media: TopSolid, SQL Server Express with the local PDM server, the Sentinel license server and TopSolid'Update. Nothing from Windows has to be installed.

topsolinux is unofficial and not affiliated with or supported by TOPSOLID SAS. You need your own TopSolid installation media and license.

1. What you need

- Ubuntu 24.04 or newer, or another 64-bit distribution with glibc 2.38 or newer.
- The TopSolid installation media (the folder with Setup .exe), or let the installer download it from TopSolid's server (19 GB).
- A TopSolid license file (lservrc), can also be added later.
- About 45 GB of free disk space and an internet connection (for Microsoft's .NET runtimes).
- A GPU with a working OpenGL driver. Laptops with NVIDIA and Intel/AMD graphics use the NVIDIA GPU automatically.
- For a SpaceMouse: `sudo apt install spacenavd`.

Do not install the package **fuse** on Ubuntu: it removes parts of the desktop. What ApplImages need (fuse3) is already there.

2. Installing

- Make `topsolinux-installer-x86_64.AppImage` executable (file properties, or `chmod +x`) and start it.
- Choose the installation media (found automatically in Downloads) or the download from TopSolid's server, your license file (or skip it for the evaluation mode), and whether to also build a TopSolid AppImage (on by default).
- TopSolid's own installer opens: choose your modules, click Install and accept the license agreement. The automatic installation of SQL Server fails under Wine: click **Cancel**, then OK, close the log window and click Close. topsolinux installs and repairs SQL Server itself.
- For a SpaceMouse, tick *SpaceMouse support*: it installs spacenavd and asks for your password.
- Wait: the whole installation takes 30 to 60 minutes. If it is interrupted, start the installer again and it continues where it stopped.

Everything is installed in `~/ .local/share/topsolinux`.

3. The TopSolid AppImage

With the AppImage option you get `TopSolid-7.20-x86_64.AppImage`, a complete, self-contained TopSolid.

- Install **Gear Lever** (Software app or Flathub), open the AppImage with it and choose *Unlock* and *Move to the app menu*. TopSolid is then in your application menu.
- On this computer the AppImage uses the existing installation. On another computer the first start copies the installation to `~/ .local/share/topsolinux`, which takes a few minutes; each user adds their own license.

- Only use it on computers you are licensed for, and do not publish it: it contains TopSolid, SQL Server Express and Microsoft's runtimes.

Without the ApplImage option the installer adds TopSolid to the application menu directly. Right-click the menu entry for TopSolid'Update, the license tool and *Stop background services*.

4. First start

- License question: answer it as you would on Windows.
- PDM connection: choose the local PDM server. The PDM user is **admin**, without a password.
- Libraries: import the ones you need from TopSolid.
- New Project: enter a name, choose Blank Template and click the green check mark.

SQL Server, the local PDM and the license server start by themselves and stop again when you close TopSolid. The very first start of the PDM can take a few minutes; a small window shows it is starting.

5. Updates

TopSolid reports new service packs itself. After *Download now* the window disappears: the download runs invisibly in the background. A little later TopSolid asks to install it, and restarts by itself afterwards.

6. Useful commands and tips

The ApplImage (or `~/ .local/share/topsolinux/runtime/AppRun` without it) accepts a command:

```
<font face="Courier">TopSolid-7.20-x86_64.ApplImage scaling=50 and icons (100 = normal), from the next start
```

```
<font face="Courier">TopSolid-7.20-x86_64.ApplImage update=TopSolid'Update
```

```
<font face="Courier">TopSolid-7.20-x86_64.ApplImage license=File License file
```

```
<font face="Courier">TopSolid-7.20-x86_64.ApplImage stop=SQL Server, the PDM and the license server
```

```
<font face="Courier">TopSolid-7.20-x86_64.ApplImage registry=Registry editor
```

- Resize a window: hold Super (the Windows key) and drag with the middle mouse button, or press Alt+F8. Dragging the window edge does not work.
- The close button does not work in some dialogs: use the green check mark or the red cross at the bottom, or Esc.
- SpaceMouse: works through spacenavd, no 3Dconnexion driver needed. Axis directions and speeds are in the registry under HKCU\Software\Wine\TDxNavLib (AxisSigns, AxisMap, TranslationSpeed, RotationSpeed).

7. If something goes wrong

- Logs: `~/ .local/share/topsolinux/install.log` (installation) and `topsolid.log` (TopSolid) in the same folder.
- *Unable to connect to the PDM server* right after starting: wait a minute, the PDM is still starting. If it stays, run the stop command and start again.
- Connecting to another PDM server (the Connection dialog) can hang under Wine: the green check mark stays grey. The helper that prevents this only runs until the first connection is saved.
- Backup: copy `~/ .local/share/topsolinux` while TopSolid is closed. Your PDM projects are in it.
- Starting over: remove that folder and install again. Your PDM projects are lost then.

Credits

The Wine changes, the installer and this guide were made with Claude (Anthropic).